

A ONE-PAGE READ FOR BEING TOLD YOU ARE NOT READY

Evidence Gap or Capability Gap?

Which problem do you actually have?

You were told you are not ready, or that you need more exposure. Before you accept it, and before you dismiss it, find out which problem you are actually holding. There are four. They call for four different responses, and mixing them up costs months. **This read does not decide in your favor by default. If the capability is not there yet, that is a real and useful result.**

THE FOUR READS

A

CAPABILITY GAP

The next role needs judgment or skill you have not built enough of yet. The work is to develop it. This is a legitimate result, not a smaller one.

B

EVIDENCE GAP

The capability may be there, but your recent work has not left proof anyone can inspect. The work is to produce evidence.

C

ACCESS GAP

The capability may be there and the evidence would exist, but you were not given a credible, visible chance to produce it. The work is to get access.

D

MORE THAN ONE

Two or three are true at once. Name each, because they do not close the same way, and one usually has to move first.

RUN THE READ

1. **Capability.** Have I done work at the level the next role requires, owning the outcome, not adjacent to someone else who owned it?

☐ Yes, clearly ☐ Partly ☐ Not yet

2. **Evidence.** Could someone outside my own account inspect proof that I did it, a result, a record, a named verifier, an observable change?

☐ Yes ☐ Thin ☐ No

3. **Access.** Was I given a credible, visible opportunity to produce that proof in the first place?

☐ Yes ☐ Limited ☐ No

Not yet on capability points to A, whatever questions 2 and 3 say. A genuine capability gap is the honest read, and it is a target, not a verdict on your worth.

Capability yes or partly, evidence thin or no, access yes points to B. You can do it. You have not been proving it.

Capability yes or partly, evidence thin or no, access limited or no points to C. The system did not let you leave a trail.

More than one no points to D. Name every read that applies on the next page.

YOUR READ



Circle the read your answers point to. If D, note which of A, B, and C apply.

In my own words, the gap is:

Now weight the four outputs by your read. **A capability gap makes Practice the main work. An evidence gap makes Prove the main work. An access gap makes Access the main work.** Fill what applies to your read in full. Leave the others thin on purpose. A short, honest tool beats a padded one.

1 WHAT I NEED TO PRACTICE

The capability to build, and the situation that would build it. Be specific about the level, not the topic.

2 WHAT I NEED TO PROVE

The evidence to produce, and who needs to be able to inspect it. Name the proof, not the promise.

3 WHAT ACCESS I MAY NEED

The opportunity, visibility, or sponsor to ask for, and the specific person who controls it.

4 WHAT I SHOULD TEST NEXT

One move in the next two weeks that would give you real information, not reassurance.

One honest read is worth more than a confident guess. If the read is A, it is not a smaller result than B or C. It is the one that tells you the truth soonest.